

COMPLETE GERMAN COURSE

All Explanations in English

German Grammar • Vocabulary • Examples • Practice

30 Complete Lessons

German Examples + English Meaning

Revision Tests • Answer Key • Reference

A structured 80-page German language course for classroom and independent study

A1-B1/B2 CORE GRAMMAR PATHWAY

GETTING STARTED

How to Use This Book

Learn German structures through English explanations, German examples, and repeated practice.

What You Will Learn

- Core German grammar from pronunciation and articles to cases, tenses, subordinate clauses, relative clauses, Konjunktiv II, and passive voice.
- Practical sentence patterns for introductions, school, work, travel, everyday conversation, and written communication.
- Case recognition, verb placement, sentence brackets, and the word-order patterns that make German structurally different from English.
- High-frequency vocabulary and model sentences that connect grammar to real communication.

Recommended Study Method

1. Read the English explanation and identify the German pattern.
2. Say every German example aloud and read its English meaning.
3. Copy two model sentences, then change one element to create new examples.
4. Complete the guided practice without checking the answer key.
5. Review mistakes by writing the grammar rule in English.

Core German Learning Checklist

- Article + noun: Learn der/die/das and plural together.
- Verb: Know the infinitive, irregular present forms, and perfect form.
- Case: Ask what grammatical role the noun/pronoun performs.
- Word order: Check finite verb position in main and subordinate clauses.
- Pronunciation: Read new vocabulary aloud instead of learning silently.
- Production: Write and speak original sentences, not only isolated rules.

Suggested 8-Week Route

- Week 1: Lessons 1-4 - pronunciation, sein, haben, and noun gender.
- Week 2: Lessons 5-8 - nouns, plurals, present tense, irregular verbs.
- Week 3: Lessons 9-12 - accusative, dative, genitive, possessives.
- Week 4: Lessons 13-16 - modals, separable verbs, word order, questions.
- Week 5: Lessons 17-20 - negation, adjectives, fixed and two-way prepositions.
- Week 6: Lessons 21-24 - time, Perfekt, Präteritum, future.
- Week 7: Lessons 25-28 - reflexives, subordinate/relative clauses, comparison.
- Week 8: Lessons 29-30 + all revision tests and answer review.

REFERENCE

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Lessons 1-15

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Learning Map - Part I

- Lessons 1-4: sound system and essential identity verbs.
- Lessons 5-8: nouns, articles, plurals, and present-tense verbs.
- Lessons 9-12: the major cases and possessive determiners.
- Lessons 13-15: modal/separable verbs and main-clause word order.

Part I Goal

- By the end of Lesson 15, you should be able to build correct basic German statements with articles, case markers, present-tense verbs, and predictable word order.

REFERENCE

Table of Contents

Lessons 16-30, revision and reference

Lesson	Topic	Pages
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21	The Perfect Tense: Perfekt	45-46
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Course Sections After Lesson 30

- Pages 65-72: Eight comprehensive revision tests.
- Pages 73-78: Answer key and correction pages.
- Page 79: High-frequency irregular German verbs.
- Page 80: One-page German grammar quick guide.

Part II Goal

- Develop control of past and future time, subordinate clauses, comparison, relative clauses, polite hypothetical language, commands, passive voice, and connected writing.

LESSON 01 - CORE GERMAN

German Alphabet and Pronunciation

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Recognize the German alphabet and special characters.
- Pronounce common vowel and consonant patterns.
- Read simple German words more confidently.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
ä, ö, ü	These umlaut vowels are separate sounds. ä is often near the vowel in "bed"; ö and ü require rounded lips.	Mädchen = girl; schön = beautiful; fünf = five.
ß	The letter ß is called Eszett or sharp s. It normally represents an /s/ sound after a long vowel or diphthong.	Straße = street; heißen = to be called.
ch	The sound changes by environment. After i/e/ä/ö/ü it is softer; after a/o/u it is farther back in the mouth.	ich = I; Buch = book.
ei / ie	ei normally sounds like English "eye"; ie normally has a long "ee" sound.	mein = my; Liebe = love.

Core Rules

- German spelling is more regular than English spelling, so learning sound patterns gives fast reading gains.
- Nouns are capitalized in German: das Haus, die Schule, der Lehrer.
- Do not pronounce German w like English w; German w is usually /v/.
- German v is often /f/ in native German words, as in Vater.

Model Sentences

- Guten Tag! - Good day!
- Ich heiße Anna. - My name is Anna.
- Die Straße ist lang. - The street is long.
- Mein Bruder liest viel. - My brother reads a lot.

Mini Vocabulary

- Buch = book
- Schule = school
- Straße = street
- schön = beautiful
- fünf = five

Study Note

- Pronunciation improves through repetition. Say each new word aloud, then compare spelling and sound.

LESSON 01 - PRACTICE

German Alphabet and Pronunciation

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
wein	Wein	German nouns must begin with a capital letter.
"ie" pronounced like English "eye"	"ie" is usually a long /i:/ sound	Compare Liebe and mein.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. How is "ei" normally pronounced?	2. How is "ie" normally pronounced?
3. What sound does German "w" usually represent?	4. Write the German special letters used in this lesson.
5. Which word contains ß: Straße or Schule?	6. Why is "Haus" capitalized?
7. Read aloud: mein, Liebe, schön, fünf.	8. Write two German nouns with capital letters.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Pronunciation improves through repetition. Say each new word aloud, then compare spelling and sound.

LESSON 02 - CORE GERMAN

Personal Pronouns and the Verb sein

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Use German subject pronouns.
- Conjugate sein in the present tense.
- Build basic identity and description sentences.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Pronouns	ich, du, er, sie, es, wir, ihr, Sie correspond to I, you, he, she, it, we, you all, they, formal you.	Wir sind müde. - We are tired.
sein	sein is highly irregular: ich bin, du bist, er/sie/es ist, wir sind, ihr seid, sie/Sie sind.	Ich bin Student. - I am a student.
Predicate nouns	After sein, a profession or identity noun often appears without an article when speaking generally.	Sie ist Ärztin. - She is a doctor.
Predicate adjectives	Adjectives after sein do not take adjective endings.	Das Buch ist interessant. - The book is interesting.

Core Rules

- Memorize sein as a complete paradigm because it appears constantly.
- German has grammatical gender, but pronouns also follow natural reference for people.
- The formal pronoun Sie is capitalized; the third-person plural sie is not.
- After sein, the complement remains nominative.

Model Sentences

- Ich bin glücklich. - I am happy.
- Du bist mein Freund. - You are my friend.
- Er ist Lehrer. - He is a teacher.
- Sie sind zu Hause. - They are at home.

Mini Vocabulary

- ich = I
- du = you, informal singular
- wir = we
- sein = to be
- müde = tired

Study Note

- When learning a German verb, always learn the forms that are irregular rather than only the infinitive.

LESSON 02 - PRACTICE

Personal Pronouns and the Verb sein

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich ist müde.	Ich bin müde.	ich uses bin.
Wir seid hier.	Wir sind hier.	wir uses sind.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Complete: Ich ___ müde.	2. Complete: Du ___ nett.
3. Complete: Wir ___ hier.	4. Complete: Ihr ___ bereit.
5. Translate: They are students.	6. Translate formally: You are very kind.
7. Write the pronoun for "he".	8. Write one sentence with sein + adjective.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- When learning a German verb, always learn the forms that are irregular rather than only the infinitive.

LESSON 03 - CORE GERMAN

The Verb haben and Basic Sentence Patterns

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Conjugate haben in the present tense.
- Use haben to express possession and common states.
- Build simple subject-verb-object sentences.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
haben	Present forms: ich habe, du hast, er/sie/es hat, wir haben, ihr habt, sie/Sie haben.	Ich habe ein Auto. - I have a car.
Possession	haben commonly expresses possession, relationships, and things available to a person.	Wir haben zwei Kinder. - We have two children.
Common expressions	German uses haben in expressions that may use "be" in English.	Ich habe Hunger. - I am hungry.
Basic order	In a normal statement, the conjugated verb is usually in position 2.	Heute habe ich Zeit. - Today I have time.

Core Rules

- The verb is position 2, not necessarily the second word; a whole phrase can fill position 1.
- Du and er/sie/es have irregular forms hast and hat.
- Learn fixed expressions: Hunger haben, Durst haben, Angst haben, Zeit haben.
- Objects after haben are usually accusative.

Model Sentences

- Ich habe eine Frage. - I have a question.
- Sie hat keine Zeit. - She has no time.
- Wir haben Durst. - We are thirsty.
- Am Montag habe ich Unterricht. - On Monday I have class.

Mini Vocabulary

- Hunger = hunger
- Durst = thirst
- Zeit = time
- Frage = question
- haben = to have

Study Note

- Practice verb-second order early. It is one of the most important patterns in German sentence building.

LESSON 03 - PRACTICE

The Verb haben and Basic Sentence Patterns

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Du habst Zeit.	Du hast Zeit.	The correct du form is hast.
Ich bin Hunger.	Ich habe Hunger.	German uses haben with Hunger.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Complete: Er ___ ein Buch.	2. Complete: Wir ___ Hunger.
3. Translate: I have time.	4. Translate: She has two brothers.
5. Put in correct order: heute / ich / Zeit / habe.	6. Write the ihr form of haben.
7. Translate: Are you thirsty? (informal)	8. Write one sentence with haben + object.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- Practice verb-second order early. It is one of the most important patterns in German sentence building.

LESSON 04 - CORE GERMAN

Noun Gender and Definite Articles

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Recognize the three grammatical genders.
- Use der, die, das in the nominative.
- Learn nouns together with their articles.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Masculine	Masculine nouns normally use der in the nominative singular.	der Tisch - the table
Feminine	Feminine nouns normally use die.	die Schule - the school
Neuter	Neuter nouns normally use das.	das Kind - the child
Plural	All plural nouns use die in the nominative, regardless of singular gender.	die Bücher - the books

Core Rules

- Gender is part of the noun and should be memorized with it.
- Some endings give clues: -ung, -heit, -keit are usually feminine; -chen and -lein are neuter.
- Days, months, seasons, and many male persons are masculine.
- Do not assume German gender from English meaning.

Model Sentences

- Der Mann ist hier. - The man is here.
- Die Frau arbeitet. - The woman works.
- Das Kind spielt. - The child plays.
- Die Bücher sind neu. - The books are new.

Mini Vocabulary

- der Mann = the man
- die Frau = the woman
- das Kind = the child
- die Stadt = the city
- das Haus = the house

Study Note

- Create vocabulary cards with the article on the front: der Tisch, not simply Tisch.

LESSON 04 - PRACTICE

Noun Gender and Definite Articles

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Tisch	der Tisch	Learn the article with the noun.
das Schule	die Schule	Schule is feminine.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Article for Tisch?	2. Article for Schule?
3. Article for Kind?	4. Plural article for Bücher?
5. What gender is Mädchen?	6. Give one common feminine ending.
7. Why should articles be memorized with nouns?	8. Write three nouns with their articles.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Create vocabulary cards with the article on the front: der Tisch, not simply Tisch.

LESSON 05 - CORE GERMAN

Indefinite Articles and Plural Nouns

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Use ein/eine in the nominative.
- Understand that plural nouns have no indefinite article.
- Recognize common plural patterns.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
ein / eine	Masculine and neuter use ein; feminine uses eine in the nominative.	ein Mann, eine Frau, ein Kind
No plural "a"	German has no plural form of ein meaning "some". A plural noun can stand alone or use other determiners.	Ich habe Bücher. - I have books.
Plural patterns	Common endings include -e, -er, -(e)n, -s, sometimes with an umlaut.	Buch → Bücher; Frau → Frauen.
Same-form plurals	Some nouns do not change visibly in the plural.	der Lehrer → die Lehrer

Core Rules

- Always learn the plural together with the noun, because there is no single universal ending.
- Many feminine nouns form plural with -(e)n.
- Many loanwords form plural with -s.
- All nominative plural nouns use die when definite.

Model Sentences

- Das ist ein Stuhl. - That is a chair.
- Das ist eine Lampe. - That is a lamp.
- Wir kaufen Autos. - We buy cars.
- Die Kinder spielen. - The children play.

Mini Vocabulary

- Stuhl = chair
- Lampe = lamp
- Auto = car
- Buch/Bücher = book/books
- Frau/Frauen = woman/women

Study Note

- Plural formation is vocabulary, not just grammar. Record singular article + plural for every new noun.

LESSON 05 - PRACTICE

Indefinite Articles and Plural Nouns

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
ein Frau	eine Frau	Feminine nominative uses eine.
eine Kind	ein Kind	Neuter nominative uses ein.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Choose ein/eine: ___ Mann.	2. Choose ein/eine: ___ Lampe.
3. Choose ein/eine: ___ Auto.	4. Plural of Frau?
5. Plural of Buch?	6. Plural article for die Kinder?
7. Correct: ein Bücher.	8. Write two singular nouns and their plurals.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Plural formation is vocabulary, not just grammar. Record singular article + plural for every new noun.

LESSON 06 - CORE GERMAN

Present Tense: Regular Verbs

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Form the present tense of regular verbs.
- Use the present for current actions, habits, and near-future context.
- Apply standard endings accurately.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Verb stem	Remove -en from most infinitives to find the stem.	machen → mach-
Endings	Typical endings: -e, -st, -t, -en, -t, -en.	ich mache, du machst, er macht...
Uses	German present covers habits, current actions, and often future meaning with a time phrase.	Morgen arbeite ich. - I work/am working tomorrow.
Stem ending in -t/-d	An extra e often appears before some endings for pronunciation.	arbeiten → du arbeitest, er arbeitet

Core Rules

- The infinitive usually ends in -en; some end in -n.
- The subject determines the verb ending.
- German often uses simple present where English uses present continuous.
- In normal statements, the conjugated verb stays in position 2.

Model Sentences

- Ich lerne jeden Tag. - I study every day.
- Du wohnst in Berlin. - You live in Berlin.
- Wir arbeiten zusammen. - We work together.
- Morgen spiele ich Fußball. - I will play football tomorrow.

Mini Vocabulary

- lernen = to learn
- wohnen = to live/reside
- arbeiten = to work
- machen = to do/make
- spielen = to play

Study Note

- Say the whole conjugation aloud as a rhythm. Regular endings become automatic with repetition.

LESSON 06 - PRACTICE

Present Tense: Regular Verbs

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich arbeiten heute.	Ich arbeite heute.	The finite verb needs the ich ending -e.
Du mache Sport.	Du machst Sport.	du usually takes -st.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Conjugate machen for ich.	2. Conjugate lernen for du.
3. Conjugate wohnen for er.	4. Conjugate arbeiten for ihr.
5. Translate: We learn German.	6. Translate: Tomorrow I work at home.
7. Correct: Sie lernen Deutsch.	8. Write one present-tense habit.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- Say the whole conjugation aloud as a rhythm. Regular endings become automatic with repetition.

LESSON 07 - CORE GERMAN

Stem-Changing and Irregular Present Verbs

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Recognize common stem changes.
- Conjugate high-frequency irregular verbs.
- Understand that many changes occur only with du and er/sie/es.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
e → i	Some verbs change e to i in du and er/sie/es.	geben → du gibst, er gibt.
e → ie	Some verbs change e to ie.	sehen → du siehst, er sieht.
a → ä	Some verbs change a to ä.	fahren → du fährst, er fährt.
Irregular high-frequency verbs	sein, haben, wissen and modal verbs must be memorized separately.	wissen → ich weiß, du weißt, er weiß.

Core Rules

- The wir, ihr, and sie/Sie forms often return to the normal stem in stem-changing verbs.
- The infinitive alone does not always predict the exact present-tense form.
- Learn irregular verbs with at least the du and er/sie/es forms.
- Spelling changes such as ß can appear in irregular forms: wissen → weiß.

Model Sentences

- Er sieht den Film. - He sees the film.
- Du fährst schnell. - You drive quickly.
- Sie nimmt einen Kaffee. - She takes a coffee.
- Er spricht Deutsch. - He speaks German.

Mini Vocabulary

- sehen = to see
- fahren = to drive/go
- geben = to give
- nehmen = to take
- sprechen = to speak

Study Note

- Mark stem-changing verbs in your vocabulary notebook with a symbol so you remember to learn extra forms.

LESSON 07 - PRACTICE

Stem-Changing and Irregular Present Verbs

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Du seht gut.	Du siehst gut.	sehen changes e → ie for du.
Er fährt nach Hause.	Er fährt nach Hause.	fahren changes a → ä for er.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. du form of sehen?	2. er form of fahren?
3. du form of geben?	4. wir form of geben?
5. Translate: He reads a book. (lesen)	6. Translate: She takes the bus. (nehmen)
7. Correct: Du sprichst Deutsch.	8. Write one stem-changing verb with its er form.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Mark stem-changing verbs in your vocabulary notebook with a symbol so you remember to learn extra forms.

LESSON 08 - CORE GERMAN

The Accusative Case

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Identify direct objects.
- Use accusative articles correctly.
- Understand the key masculine article change.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Direct object	The accusative commonly marks the person or thing directly affected by the verb.	Ich sehe den Mann. - I see the man.
Definite articles	Masculine der → den; feminine die, neuter das, plural die stay the same.	der Mann → Ich sehe den Mann.
Indefinite articles	Masculine ein → einen; feminine eine and neuter ein remain unchanged.	Ich kaufe einen Computer.
Accusative pronouns	mich, dich, ihn, sie, es, uns, euch, sie, Sie.	Er kennt mich. - He knows me.

Core Rules

- Ask “whom or what?” after many action verbs to identify the direct object.
- Only masculine singular articles visibly change in the basic accusative article system.
- Common accusative verbs include haben, sehen, kaufen, brauchen, finden.
- Some prepositions always take accusative: durch, für, gegen, ohne, um.

Model Sentences

- Ich kaufe den Computer. - I buy the computer.
- Er hat einen Hund. - He has a dog.
- Wir besuchen die Stadt. - We visit the city.
- Das Geschenk ist für dich. - The gift is for you.

Mini Vocabulary

- den = the, masculine accusative
- einen = a/an, masculine accusative
- mich = me
- dich = you, accusative
- für = for

Study Note

- The fastest accusative rule to remember: masculine der/ein changes to den/einen.

LESSON 08 - PRACTICE

The Accusative Case

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich sehe der Mann.	Ich sehe den Mann.	Masculine direct object requires den.
Sie kauft ein Kaffee.	Sie kauft einen Kaffee.	Kaffee is masculine and accusative.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Change: der Mann → accusative.	2. Change: ein Hund → accusative.
3. Translate: I see the woman.	4. Translate: We need a car.
5. Accusative pronoun for du?	6. Choose: für der/den Freund.
7. Correct: Ich habe ein Bruder.	8. Write one sentence with einen.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- The fastest accusative rule to remember: masculine der/ein changes to den/einen.

LESSON 09 - CORE GERMAN

The Dative Case

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Identify common indirect-object functions.
- Use dative articles and pronouns.
- Recognize frequent dative verbs and prepositions.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Indirect object	The dative often marks the recipient or beneficiary.	Ich gebe dem Kind ein Buch. - I give the child a book.
Definite articles	der → dem, die → der, das → dem, plural die → den (+ noun often -n).	mit dem Mann; mit der Frau.
Indefinite articles	ein → einem, eine → einer, ein → einem.	Ich spreche mit einer Kollegin.
Dative pronouns	mir, dir, ihm, ihr, ihm, uns, euch, ihnen, Ihnen.	Kannst du mir helfen? - Can you help me?

Core Rules

- Common dative prepositions: aus, bei, mit, nach, seit, von, zu.
- Some verbs govern dative, especially helfen, danken, gefallen, gehören.
- Plural dative nouns often add -n when possible: mit den Kindern.
- Formal Ihnen is capitalized.

Model Sentences

- Ich fahre mit dem Bus. - I travel by bus.
- Wir helfen der Frau. - We help the woman.
- Das Buch gehört mir. - The book belongs to me.
- Er spricht mit seinen Freunden. - He speaks with his friends.

Mini Vocabulary

- mir = to/for me
- dir = to/for you
- mit = with/by
- zu = to
- helfen = to help

Study Note

- Memorize dative prepositions as a group. They make case choice much easier.

LESSON 09 - PRACTICE

The Dative Case

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
mit den Mann	mit dem Mann	mit always takes dative.
Ich helfe dich.	Ich helfe dir.	helfen governs dative.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Dative of der Mann?	2. Dative of die Frau?
3. Dative of ein Kind?	4. Dative pronoun for ich?
5. Translate: I help him.	6. Choose: mit dem/den Auto.
7. Correct: Sie dankt mich.	8. Write one sentence with zu + dative.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Memorize dative prepositions as a group. They make case choice much easier.

LESSON 10 - CORE GERMAN

Genitive and Possession

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Understand the genitive as a possession/relationship case.
- Use basic genitive articles.
- Choose natural alternatives with von + dative.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Function	The genitive often expresses possession or close relationship.	das Auto des Mannes - the man's car.
Articles	Masculine/neuter: des; feminine/plural: der.	die Farbe des Hauses; die Tür der Schule.
Noun endings	Masculine/neuter singular nouns commonly add -s or -es in the genitive.	des Kindes; des Lehrers.
von alternative	In everyday speech, von + dative is common for possession.	das Auto von meinem Bruder.

Core Rules

- Genitive is more common in formal writing than in casual speech.
- One-syllable masculine/neuter nouns often take -es; longer nouns often take -s, though variation exists.
- Proper names can take -s without an apostrophe in normal German: Annas Buch.
- Do not use an English possessive apostrophe before s.

Model Sentences

- Das ist Marias Tasche. - That is Maria's bag.
- Die Hauptstadt Deutschlands ist Berlin. - Germany's capital is Berlin.
- Die Tür des Hauses ist offen. - The door of the house is open.
- Das Fahrrad von meinem Bruder ist neu. - My brother's bike is new.

Mini Vocabulary

- Besitz = possession
- des = of the, masc/neut genitive
- der = of the, fem/pl genitive
- Haus = house
- Vater = father

Study Note

- For everyday communication, understand the genitive but feel comfortable using von + dative when appropriate.

LESSON 10 - PRACTICE

Genitive and Possession

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Anna's Buch	Annas Buch	German normally uses no apostrophe for regular possessive names.
das Auto der Mann	das Auto des Mannes	Masculine genitive requires des and noun ending.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Genitive article for masculine?	2. Genitive article for feminine?
3. Complete: die Tür ____ Hauses.	4. Write the possessive: Anna + Buch.
5. Rewrite with von: das Auto meines Vaters.	6. Translate: the color of the house.
7. Correct: Peter's Fahrrad.	8. Give one context where genitive is common.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- For everyday communication, understand the genitive but feel comfortable using von + dative when appropriate.

LESSON 11 - CORE GERMAN

Possessive Determiners

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Use mein, dein, sein, ihr, unser, euer, ihr, Ihr.
- Make possessives agree with the following noun.
- Distinguish owner from noun gender.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Possessive roots	mein=my, dein=your, sein=his/its, ihr=her/their, unser=our, euer=your plural, Ihr=formal your.	mein Bruder - my brother.
Agreement	Possessives take endings similar to ein-words according to gender, case, and number.	meine Schwester; meinen Bruder.
Owner vs noun	The root shows the owner; the ending agrees with the noun being possessed.	sein Vater / seine Mutter.
euer	euer often loses an e when an ending is added.	eure Freunde - your friends.

Core Rules

- Do not choose sein/ihr based on the possessed noun; choose it based on who owns the noun.
- Nominative feminine and plural usually take -e: meine Mutter, meine Freunde.
- Masculine accusative takes -en: meinen Bruder.
- Formal Ihr is capitalized.

Model Sentences

- Meine Familie ist groß. - My family is large.
- Sein Auto ist neu. - His car is new.
- Ihre Schwester wohnt hier. - Her sister lives here.
- Wir besuchen unsere Freunde. - We visit our friends.

Mini Vocabulary

- mein = my
- dein = your
- sein = his/its
- ihr = her/their
- unser = our

Study Note

- Think in two steps: Who owns it? Then: What gender/case/number is the noun that follows?

LESSON 11 - PRACTICE

Possessive Determiners

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
sein Mutter	seine Mutter	Mutter is feminine, so an ending -e is needed.
ich Bruder	mein Bruder	Use the possessive determiner mein.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Translate: my father.	2. Translate: my mother.
3. Translate: his sister.	4. Translate: our house.
5. Accusative: I see my brother.	6. Formal: your name.
7. Correct: ihr Bruder if "his brother".	8. Write one sentence with unsere.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Think in two steps: Who owns it? Then: What gender/case/number is the noun that follows?

LESSON 12 - CORE GERMAN

Modal Verbs

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Use können, müssen, wollen, sollen, dürfen, mögen/möchten.
- Build sentences with a modal plus infinitive.
- Express ability, necessity, permission, intention, and polite wishes.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Sentence frame	The modal is conjugated in position 2; the main infinitive goes to the end.	Ich kann Deutsch sprechen.
können	Expresses ability or possibility.	Kannst du schwimmen? - Can you swim?
müssen / dürfen	müssen = must/have to; dürfen = may/be allowed to.	Wir müssen gehen. / Darf ich kommen?
möchten	möchten is a common polite form for "would like".	Ich möchte einen Kaffee.

Core Rules

- Modal verbs are irregular and often change their stem in singular forms.
- With a modal, the main verb normally remains an infinitive at the end.
- Nicht müssen means "do not have to"; nicht dürfen means "must not / not allowed".
- Use möchten for polite ordering and requests.

Model Sentences

- Ich kann heute kommen. - I can come today.
- Du musst mehr lernen. - You must study more.
- Wir dürfen hier parken. - We may park here.
- Ich möchte bezahlen. - I would like to pay.

Mini Vocabulary

- können = can/to be able
- müssen = must
- dürfen = may/be allowed
- wollen = to want
- möchten = would like

Study Note

- Modal verbs create a sentence bracket: the conjugated modal is near the front and the infinitive closes the sentence.

LESSON 12 - PRACTICE

Modal Verbs

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich kann spreche Deutsch.	Ich kann Deutsch sprechen.	The main verb stays infinitive at the end.
Du musst zu gehen.	Du musst gehen.	No zu after a modal.
Ich möchte Kaffee einen	Ich möchte einen Kaffee	The object stays before the final infinitive position

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Translate: I can swim.	2. Translate: We must work.
3. Ask: May I come in?	4. Translate: She wants to learn German.
5. Difference: nicht müssen vs nicht dürfen?	6. Correct: Ich kann zu fahren.
7. Order politely: I would like a tea.	8. Write one sentence with sollen.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- Modal verbs create a sentence bracket: the conjugated modal is near the front and the infinitive closes the sentence.

LESSON 13 - CORE GERMAN

Separable and Inseparable Verbs

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Recognize common separable prefixes.
- Place separable prefixes correctly in main clauses.
- Distinguish inseparable prefixes.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Separable verbs	Common prefixes include an-, auf-, aus-, ein-, mit-, vor-, zu-. The prefix separates in a main clause.	Ich stehe um 7 Uhr auf.
Infinitive	In the infinitive, prefix and verb are written together.	aufstehen - to get up.
Inseparable prefixes	be-, emp-, ent-, er-, ge-, miss-, ver-, zer- usually do not separate.	Ich verstehe die Frage.
Perfect form	Separable verbs usually insert ge between prefix and stem; inseparable verbs do not use ge.	aufgemacht / verstanden.

Core Rules

- The separated prefix normally goes to the end of a simple main clause.
- With a modal, the full infinitive stays together at the end: Ich muss früh aufstehen.
- In subordinate clauses, a separable verb is written together at the end: weil ich früh aufstehe.
- Learn verbs as whole lexical units because the prefix changes meaning.

Model Sentences

- Der Zug kommt um acht Uhr an. - The train arrives at eight.
- Ich mache das Fenster auf. - I open the window.
- Sie kauft im Supermarkt ein. - She shops at the supermarket.
- Er versteht die Aufgabe. - He understands the task.

Mini Vocabulary

- aufstehen = to get up
- anrufen = to call
- einkaufen = to shop
- ankommen = to arrive
- verstehen = to understand

Study Note

- Listen for the prefix at the end of sentences. It often carries essential meaning.

LESSON 13 - PRACTICE

Separable and Inseparable Verbs

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich aufstehe früh.	Ich stehe früh auf.	The prefix separates in a main clause.
Ich verstehe die Frage nicht aus.	Ich verstehe die Frage nicht.	verstehen is inseparable.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Separate: aufstehen in "I get up at 6."	2. Translate: I call my mother. (anrufen)
3. Is verstehen separable?	4. Perfect participle of aufmachen?
5. Perfect participle of verkaufen?	6. Correct: Wir einkaufen heute.
7. With modal: I must get up early.	8. Give one separable prefix.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Listen for the prefix at the end of sentences. It often carries essential meaning.

LESSON 14 - CORE GERMAN

Word Order in Main Clauses

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Apply the verb-second rule.
- Use inversion when another element comes first.
- Place time, manner, and place information naturally.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Verb second	In a declarative main clause, the conjugated verb occupies position 2.	Ich lerne heute Deutsch.
Inversion	If time/place/object comes first, the subject usually follows the verb.	Heute lerne ich Deutsch.
Sentence bracket	With modals, separable verbs, or perfect tense, another verb element often appears at the end.	Ich habe gestern viel gearbeitet.
Middle field	A useful learner pattern is time-manner-place for many adverbials.	Ich fahre morgen mit dem Bus nach Berlin.

Core Rules

- Position 1 may contain one word or a whole phrase.
- Never keep subject + verb order unchanged after moving a different element into position 1.
- Pronouns often appear earlier than full noun objects.
- German word order is flexible, but verb position is structurally strict.

Model Sentences

- Jetzt esse ich Frühstück. - Now I eat breakfast.
- Am Wochenende besuche ich Freunde. - At the weekend I visit friends.
- Heute muss ich lange arbeiten. - Today I have to work long.
- Danach gehe ich nach Hause. - After that I go home.

Mini Vocabulary

- heute = today
- morgen = tomorrow
- danach = after that
- am Abend = in the evening
- zu Hause = at home

Study Note

- When writing, underline the finite verb. If it is not in position 2 in a statement, check your word order.

LESSON 14 - PRACTICE

Word Order in Main Clauses

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Heute ich lerne Deutsch.	Heute lerne ich Deutsch.	The verb remains in position 2.
Morgen nach Berlin ich fahre.	Morgen fahre ich nach Berlin.	Use inversion after the initial time phrase.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Reorder: heute / ich / arbeite.	2. Start with "Morgen": Ich fahre nach Tana.
3. Reorder: mit dem Bus / zur Schule / ich / fahre / jeden Tag.	4. Where is the finite verb in a normal main clause?
5. Correct: Am Montag ich habe Unterricht.	6. Write a sentence beginning with Heute.
7. Translate: In the evening we watch TV.	8. Identify the sentence bracket in: Ich muss morgen arbeiten.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- When writing, underline the finite verb. If it is not in position 2 in a statement, check your word order.

LESSON 15 - CORE GERMAN

Questions

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Form yes/no questions.
- Use common question words.
- Ask formal and informal questions accurately.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Yes/no questions	The conjugated verb comes first.	Kommst du aus Berlin? - Do you come from Berlin?
W-questions	Question word + verb + subject is a common pattern.	Wo wohnst du? - Where do you live?
Common question words	wer, was, wo, wohin, woher, wann, warum, wie, welcher.	Warum lernst du Deutsch?
Case in questions	wer changes by case: wen = whom (acc.), wem = to whom (dat.).	Wem gibst du das Buch?

Core Rules

- No do/does auxiliary is needed in German questions.
- Use wo for location, wohin for destination, woher for origin.
- Formal questions use Sie with the appropriate verb form.
- The finite verb still appears early: first in yes/no questions, second after the question word in W-questions.

Model Sentences

- Wie geht es dir? - How are you?
- Wann beginnt der Kurs? - When does the course start?
- Warum bist du müde? - Why are you tired?
- Welche Sprache sprichst du? - Which language do you speak?

Mini Vocabulary

- wer = who
- was = what
- wo = where
- wann = when
- warum = why

Study Note

- Practice questions as mini-dialogues. Grammar becomes easier when every question is paired with a natural answer.

LESSON 15 - PRACTICE

Questions

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Wo du wohnst?	Wo wohnst du?	Verb follows the question word.
Do du Deutsch sprechen?	Sprichst du Deutsch?	German does not use do-support.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Make a yes/no question: Du arbeitest heute.	2. Ask: Where do you live?
3. Ask: Where are you going?	4. Ask: Where are you from?
5. Ask formally: Do you speak German?	6. Accusative form of wer?
7. Dative form of wer?	8. Write one warum question.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Practice questions as mini-dialogues. Grammar becomes easier when every question is paired with a natural answer.

LESSON 16 - CORE GERMAN

Negation: nicht and kein

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Choose between nicht and kein.
- Place nicht in common sentence positions.
- Negate nouns, adjectives, adverbs, and whole clauses.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
kein	Use kein with an indefinite or zero-article noun. It behaves like ein with endings.	Ich habe kein Auto.
nicht	Use nicht to negate verbs, adjectives, adverbs, definite nouns, or a whole statement.	Das ist nicht teuer.
kein forms	kein, keine, keinen, keinem etc. change for gender and case.	Ich sehe keinen Mann.
Position of nicht	nicht usually comes before the element being specifically negated, or later in the clause for general negation.	Ich komme heute nicht.

Core Rules

- If the affirmative sentence would use ein/eine or no article, kein is often the natural noun negator.
- Use nicht before adjectives: nicht gut, nicht teuer.
- Use nicht with names and definite articles when negating them: nicht der Lehrer.
- Negation position can change emphasis, so begin with simple standard patterns.

Model Sentences

- Ich spreche nicht gut Deutsch. - I do not speak German well.
- Wir haben keine Zeit. - We have no time.
- Das Essen ist nicht teuer. - The food is not expensive.
- Er kauft keinen Computer. - He buys no computer.

Mini Vocabulary

- nicht = not
- kein = no/not any
- keine Zeit = no time
- kein Geld = no money
- keinen Kaffee = no coffee

Study Note

- A useful shortcut: kein negates "a/an/any + noun"; nicht negates most other sentence elements.

LESSON 16 - PRACTICE

Negation: nicht and kein

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich habe nicht Auto.	Ich habe kein Auto.	A noun with no article is normally negated by kein.
Das ist kein gut.	Das ist nicht gut.	Adjectives use nicht.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Choose: Ich habe nicht/kein Geld.	2. Choose: Das ist nicht/kein interessant.
3. Translate: She has no brother.	4. Translate: We are not tired.
5. Accusative masculine: no dog.	6. Correct: Ich trinke nicht Kaffee.
7. Negate: Er kommt heute.	8. Write one sentence with keine.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- A useful shortcut: kein negates "a/an/any + noun"; nicht negates most other sentence elements.

LESSON 17 - CORE GERMAN

Adjectives and Adjective Endings

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Use adjectives after sein without endings.
- Understand attributive adjective endings.
- Apply common endings after definite and indefinite articles.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Predicate adjective	After sein/werden/bleiben, adjectives have no ending.	Der Film ist interessant.
Before a noun	An adjective before a noun takes an ending that helps show gender, case, and number.	ein interessantes Buch.
After definite article	Common nominative forms: der gute Mann, die gute Frau, das gute Kind, die guten Leute.	der neue Computer.
After ein-word	Nominative: ein guter Mann, eine gute Frau, ein gutes Kind.	ein kleines Haus.

Core Rules

- Adjective endings are part of the case system, so learn them after articles/cases.
- Plural adjectives after a definite article commonly take -en: die guten Bücher.
- Masculine accusative after definite/indefinite article: den guten Mann / einen guten Mann.
- Do not add an ending to a predicate adjective: Das Haus ist groß.

Model Sentences

- Das ist ein gutes Buch. - That is a good book.
- Wir sehen einen alten Film. - We watch an old film.
- Die neuen Schüler sind hier. - The new students are here.
- Der Kaffee ist heiß. - The coffee is hot.

Mini Vocabulary

- gut = good
- neu = new
- alt = old
- klein = small
- groß = big/tall

Study Note

- Do not try to memorize every adjective-ending table at once. Master common nominative and accusative patterns first.

LESSON 17 - PRACTICE

Adjectives and Adjective Endings

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Das Haus ist großes.	Das Haus ist groß.	Predicate adjectives take no ending.
ein gut Mann	ein guter Mann	Nominative masculine after ein requires -er.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Complete: der ___ Mann (gut).	2. Complete: eine ___ Frau (nett).
3. Complete: ein ___ Kind (klein).	4. Complete: die ___ Bücher (neu).
5. Predicate: Das Auto ist ___. (schnell)	6. Accusative: einen ___ Kaffee (heiß).
7. Correct: ein schön Haus.	8. Write one phrase with adjective + noun.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Do not try to memorize every adjective-ending table at once. Master common nominative and accusative patterns first.

LESSON 18 - CORE GERMAN

Prepositions with Accusative or Dative

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Recognize fixed accusative prepositions.
- Recognize fixed dative prepositions.
- Apply the required case after each group.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Accusative group	durch, für, gegen, ohne, um normally take accusative.	für meinen Freund; ohne das Auto.
Dative group	aus, außer, bei, mit, nach, seit, von, zu normally take dative.	mit dem Bus; aus der Stadt.
Contractions	Some preposition + article combinations contract.	zum = zu dem; zur = zu der; vom = von dem.
Meaning first	Prepositions express relationships such as direction, source, accompaniment, time, or purpose.	Ich fahre nach Berlin.

Core Rules

- Memorize preposition groups with a rhythm or mnemonic.
- nach is common with cities/countries without articles and with "home": nach Hause.
- zu is common for people and many destinations: zum Arzt, zur Schule.
- mit always takes dative, even when English would not show a case difference.

Model Sentences

- Ich gehe ohne meinen Bruder. - I go without my brother.
- Wir fahren mit dem Zug. - We travel by train.
- Sie kommt aus der Schweiz. - She comes from Switzerland.
- Er geht zum Arzt. - He goes to the doctor.

Mini Vocabulary

- für = for
- ohne = without
- mit = with
- aus = from/out of
- zu = to

Study Note

- Case choice after fixed prepositions is not optional. Learn the preposition together with its case.

LESSON 18 - PRACTICE

Prepositions with Accusative or Dative

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
mit den Bus	mit dem Bus	mit takes dative.
für dem Freund	für den Freund	für takes accusative.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Case after für?	2. Case after mit?
3. Translate: with the teacher.	4. Translate: for the child.
5. Expand zum.	6. Expand zur.
7. Correct: Ich komme aus die Stadt.	8. Write one sentence with nach.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Case choice after fixed prepositions is not optional. Learn the preposition together with its case.

LESSON 19 - CORE GERMAN

Two-Way Prepositions

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Recognize the main two-way prepositions.
- Choose accusative for destination/change of location.
- Choose dative for location/state.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Two-way group	an, auf, hinter, in, neben, über, unter, vor, zwischen can take accusative or dative.	in die Schule / in der Schule.
Accusative	Use accusative when the phrase expresses movement toward a destination or change of location: wohin?	Ich gehe in die Küche.
Dative	Use dative when the phrase expresses a location or position: wo?	Ich bin in der Küche.
Verb meaning	Motion alone does not automatically mean accusative; focus on destination vs location.	Ich laufe im Park. - I run in the park (location).

Core Rules

- Ask wohin? for destination and wo? for location.
- in + das = ins; in + dem = im; an + das = ans; an + dem = am.
- Some verbs naturally pair with position (stehen, liegen, sitzen) or placement (stellen, legen, setzen).
- Context determines case with these prepositions.

Model Sentences

- Ich stelle die Flasche auf den Tisch. - I put the bottle onto the table.
- Die Flasche steht auf dem Tisch. - The bottle is on the table.
- Wir gehen ins Kino. - We go to the cinema.
- Wir sind im Kino. - We are at the cinema.

Mini Vocabulary

- in = in/into
- auf = on/onto
- an = at/on
- zwischen = between
- unter = under

Study Note

- Always connect two-way prepositions to the questions wo? and wohin? rather than simply "movement vs no movement".

LESSON 19 - PRACTICE

Two-Way Prepositions

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich bin in die Schule.	Ich bin in der Schule.	A location uses dative.
Ich gehe in der Schule. [destination]	Ich gehe in die Schule.	Destination uses accusative.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Choose: Ich bin in der/die Stadt.	2. Choose: Ich fahre in der/die Stadt.
3. Contract: in das Haus.	4. Contract: in dem Haus.
5. Question for destination?	6. Question for location?
7. Correct: Das Buch liegt auf den Tisch.	8. Write one pair showing movement vs location.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Always connect two-way prepositions to the questions wo? and wohin? rather than simply "movement vs no movement".

LESSON 20 - CORE GERMAN

Time, Dates, Numbers and Frequency

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Tell time and give dates.
- Use common time prepositions.
- Express frequency and routines.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Clock time	Use um for clock times.	Der Kurs beginnt um 8 Uhr.
Days/dates	Use am with days and many date expressions.	am Montag; am dritten Mai.
Months/years	Use im with months/seasons; years often have no preposition in simple date statements.	im Juli; im Winter; 2026.
Frequency	oft, immer, manchmal, selten, nie and jeden Tag express frequency.	Ich lerne jeden Tag.

Core Rules

- German date order is day-month-year.
- Ordinal numbers are used in dates, with endings according to context.
- Use von ... bis ... for time ranges.
- Frequency adverbs often appear in the middle field after the finite verb or after a time element.

Model Sentences

- Es ist zehn Uhr. - It is ten o'clock.
- Wir treffen uns um halb neun. - We meet at 8:30.
- Am Freitag habe ich frei. - I am free on Friday.
- Im Dezember ist es oft warm. - In December it is often warm.

Mini Vocabulary

- Uhr = o'clock/clock
- Montag = Monday
- heute = today
- oft = often
- nie = never

Study Note

- German "halb neun" means half before nine, i.e. 8:30. This differs from some English-speaking habits.

LESSON 20 - PRACTICE

Time, Dates, Numbers and Frequency

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
in Montag	am Montag	Days normally use am.
um Juli	im Juli	Months normally use im.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Preposition for 7:30?	2. Preposition for Monday?
3. Preposition for August?	4. Translate: every day.
5. Translate: from 8 to 10.	6. Write 14:30 in words (common style).
7. Correct: Ich arbeite in Montag.	8. Write one sentence with manchmal.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- German “halb neun” means half before nine, i.e. 8:30. This differs from some English-speaking habits.

LESSON 21 - CORE GERMAN

The Perfect Tense: Perfekt

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Form the conversational past with haben/sein + past participle.
- Choose between haben and sein.
- Build regular and common irregular participles.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Structure	The auxiliary is conjugated in position 2; the past participle goes to the end.	Ich habe Deutsch gelernt.
haben	Most verbs form Perfekt with haben.	Wir haben gearbeitet.
sein	Many verbs of movement/change of state and sein itself use sein.	Er ist nach Hause gegangen.
Participles	Regular: ge- + stem + -t; many irregular: ge- + changed stem + -en.	machen → gemacht; sehen → gesehen.

Core Rules

- Separable verbs insert ge: anrufen → angerufen.
- Inseparable verbs with be-, ver-, er-, etc. usually do not take ge: verkauft.
- Verbs ending in -ieren do not take ge: studiert.
- Perfekt is very common in spoken German for past events.

Model Sentences

- Ich habe gestern gearbeitet. - I worked yesterday.
- Sie ist früh aufgestanden. - She got up early.
- Wir haben den Film gesehen. - We saw the film.
- Bist du schon angekommen? - Have you arrived already?

Mini Vocabulary

- gemacht = done/made
- gesehen = seen
- gegangen = gone
- gekommen = come
- gearbeitet = worked

Study Note

- Learn each common irregular verb with its perfect form: gehen - ist gegangen; sehen - hat gesehen.

LESSON 21 - PRACTICE

The Perfect Tense: Perfekt

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich habe gegangen.	Ich bin gegangen.	gehen uses sein in Perfekt.
Ich habe gemacht.	Ich habe gemacht.	Regular participle ends in -t.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Participle of machen?	2. Participle of lernen?
3. Perfect: Ich ___ nach Berlin gefahren.	4. Perfect: Wir ___ viel gearbeitet.
5. Participle of anrufen?	6. Participle of verkaufen?
7. Correct: Er hat gekommen.	8. Translate: I have eaten.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Learn each common irregular verb with its perfect form: gehen - ist gegangen; sehen - hat gesehen.

LESSON 22 - CORE GERMAN

The Simple Past: Präteritum

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Recognize the simple past.
- Use common Präteritum forms of sein, haben, and modal verbs.
- Understand written vs spoken preferences.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Regular form	Regular verbs use stem + -te + personal endings.	machen → ich machte.
sein / haben	sein: war; haben: hatte are extremely common.	Ich war müde. / Ich hatte Zeit.
Modal verbs	Modal verbs commonly appear in Präteritum even in conversation.	Ich konnte nicht kommen.
Usage	Präteritum is frequent in written narrative; Perfekt dominates much everyday speech for many verbs.	Er ging nach Hause. - He went home.

Core Rules

- Memorize war/wären and hatte/hätten early.
- Modal Präteritum forms include konnte, musste, wollte, durfte, sollte.
- Strong verbs may change their stem: gehen → ging, sehen → sah.
- Do not combine a Präteritum finite verb with a Perfekt participle unless the grammar requires another construction.

Model Sentences

- Als Kind war ich ruhig. - As a child I was quiet.
- Wir hatten viel Arbeit. - We had a lot of work.
- Sie musste früh gehen. - She had to leave early.
- Er schrieb einen Brief. - He wrote a letter.

Mini Vocabulary

- war = was
- hatte = had
- konnte = could
- musste = had to
- ging = went

Study Note

- For active speaking, master Perfekt plus the Präteritum of sein, haben, and modals first.

LESSON 22 - PRACTICE

The Simple Past: Präteritum

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich bin gestern müde. [past]	Ich war gestern müde.	Use past form war.
Wir hatten gegangen.	Wir waren gegangen / Wir gingen.	Do not mix basic tense patterns.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Past of sein for ich?	2. Past of haben for wir?
3. Past of können for ich?	4. Past of gehen for er?
5. Translate: We were at home.	6. Translate: I had no time.
7. Correct: Gestern ich war krank.	8. Write one sentence with musste.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- For active speaking, master Perfekt plus the Präteritum of sein, haben, and modals first.

LESSON 23 - CORE GERMAN

Future with werden

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Form Futur I with werden + infinitive.
- Express predictions, promises, and future plans.
- Know when present tense is more natural.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Structure	Conjugated werden is in position 2; the infinitive goes to the end.	Ich werde morgen arbeiten.
Prediction	Futur I can express a prediction or assumption.	Es wird morgen regnen.
Future intention	It can also express a future action, especially for emphasis or formality.	Wir werden das Problem lösen.
Present alternative	German often uses present tense + future time expression for planned events.	Morgen fahre ich nach Berlin.

Core Rules

- werden forms: ich werde, du wirst, er/sie/es wird, wir werden, ihr werdet, sie/Sie werden.
- Do not use werden when a simple present with a clear future time phrase sounds more natural.
- The final infinitive remains uninflected.
- Futur I is not required every time English uses "will".

Model Sentences

- Ich werde dich anrufen. - I will call you.
- Bald wird es besser. - It will get better soon.
- Wir werden morgen beginnen. - We will begin tomorrow.
- Nächste Woche fliege ich nach Paris. - Next week I fly to Paris.

Mini Vocabulary

- werden = to become / future auxiliary
- bald = soon
- morgen = tomorrow
- nächste Woche = next week
- regnen = to rain

Study Note

- In everyday German, future time is often expressed by the present tense. Use Futur I when it adds emphasis, prediction, or clarity.

LESSON 23 - PRACTICE

Future with werden

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich werde arbeite.	Ich werde arbeiten.	Use the infinitive at the end.
Du werdest kommen.	Du wirst kommen.	The du form is wirst.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. ich form of werden?	2. du form of werden?
3. Translate: It will rain.	4. Translate: We will learn a lot.
5. Correct: Er wird kommt.	6. Rewrite naturally with present: Ich werde morgen nach Hause fahren.
7. Write one prediction.	8. Where does the infinitive go?

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- In everyday German, future time is often expressed by the present tense. Use Futur I when it adds emphasis, prediction, or clarity.

LESSON 24 - CORE GERMAN

Reflexive Verbs

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Use reflexive pronouns in accusative and common dative patterns.
- Recognize verbs that are normally reflexive.
- Place reflexive pronouns naturally.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Accusative reflexive	mich, dich, sich, uns, euch, sich are used when subject and object refer to the same person.	Ich wasche mich.
Common reflexive verbs	sich interessieren, sich freuen, sich erinnern, sich treffen, sich beeilen.	Ich interessiere mich für Musik.
Dative reflexive	When another accusative object is present, the reflexive pronoun may be dative: mir, dir, sich...	Ich wasche mir die Hände.
Word order	The reflexive pronoun usually appears early in the middle field.	Heute treffe ich mich mit Anna.

Core Rules

- Learn reflexive verbs with sich and any required preposition.
- Third person uses sich for singular and plural.
- Some German reflexive verbs are not reflexive in English, and vice versa.
- Case depends on the verb pattern and other objects.

Model Sentences

- Ich beeile mich. - I hurry.
- Wir freuen uns auf den Urlaub. - We look forward to the vacation.
- Er erinnert sich an mich. - He remembers me.
- Sie zieht sich schnell an. - She gets dressed quickly.

Mini Vocabulary

- sich freuen = to be glad/look forward
- sich treffen = to meet
- sich erinnern = to remember
- sich beeilen = to hurry
- sich interessieren = to be interested

Study Note

- Record reflexive verbs as complete phrases: sich interessieren für + accusative, not only interessieren.

LESSON 24 - PRACTICE

Reflexive Verbs

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich interessiere für Musik.	Ich interessiere mich für Musik.	The verb is reflexive.
Er freut ihn. [he is happy]	Er freut sich.	Reflexive third person is sich.
Ich wasche mich die Hände.	Ich wasche mir die Hände.	With Hände as accusative object, reflexive pronoun is

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Reflexive pronoun for ich?	2. for du?
3. for er?	4. Translate: We meet at 8.
5. Translate: I am interested in German.	6. Correct: Sie erinnert an den Termin.
7. Dative reflexive for ich?	8. Write one sentence with sich freuen.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- Record reflexive verbs as complete phrases: sich interessieren für + accusative, not only interessieren.

LESSON 25 - CORE GERMAN

Subordinate Clauses

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Form clauses with weil, dass, wenn, obwohl, and other subordinators.
- Move the finite verb to the end.
- Combine main and subordinate clauses.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Verb-final rule	In a subordinate clause, the finite verb normally moves to the end.	..., weil ich müde bin.
weil	Introduces a reason.	Ich bleibe zu Hause, weil ich krank bin.
dass	Introduces a content clause after verbs such as sagen, denken, glauben.	Ich glaube, dass er kommt.
wenn / obwohl	wenn = if/when (repeated/present/future); obwohl = although.	Wenn ich Zeit habe, komme ich.

Core Rules

- A comma separates the subordinate clause from the main clause.
- If the subordinate clause comes first, the main clause begins with the finite verb: Weil ich krank bin, bleibe ich zu Hause.
- With two-part verb forms, the verb cluster appears at the end: weil ich gearbeitet habe.
- Do not keep normal verb-second order inside a standard subordinate clause.

Model Sentences

- Ich weiß, dass du Recht hast. - I know that you are right.
- Weil es spät ist, gehen wir nach Hause. - Because it is late, we go home.
- Wenn ich frei habe, lese ich. - When I am free, I read.
- Obwohl er müde ist, arbeitet er. - Although he is tired, he works.

Mini Vocabulary

- weil = because
- dass = that
- wenn = if/when
- obwohl = although
- deshalb = therefore

Study Note

- Subordinate clauses are easier if you deliberately “save” the conjugated verb until the end.

LESSON 25 - PRACTICE

Subordinate Clauses

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
weil ich bin müde	weil ich müde bin	Finite verb goes to the end.
Ich glaube dass er kommt.	Ich glaube, dass er kommt.	A comma is required.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Complete: weil ich müde ____.	2. Order: dass / Deutsch / sie / lernt.
3. Join: Ich bleibe zu Hause. Ich bin krank.	4. Translate: If I have time, I will come.
5. Translate: Although it rains, we go out.	6. Correct: weil er hat gearbeitet.
7. What punctuation separates clauses?	8. Write one dass-clause.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- Subordinate clauses are easier if you deliberately “save” the conjugated verb until the end.

LESSON 26 - CORE GERMAN

Relative Clauses

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Use basic relative pronouns.
- Understand that the relative pronoun reflects gender/number and case.
- Place the verb at the end of the relative clause.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Function	Relative clauses add information about a noun.	Der Mann, der dort steht, ist mein Lehrer.
Nominative	der/die/das/die can function as subject relative pronouns.	Die Frau, die hier arbeitet...
Accusative/dative	Case depends on the pronoun's function inside the relative clause.	Der Mann, den ich sehe... / dem ich helfe...
Word order	Relative clauses are subordinate: the finite verb goes to the end.	Das Buch, das ich gekauft habe, ist gut.

Core Rules

- The relative pronoun matches the antecedent in gender and number, but its case comes from its role in the relative clause.
- Commas set off relative clauses.
- Do not use English who/which forms directly; German uses article-like relative pronouns.
- Prepositions may come before the relative pronoun: mit dem, für den, etc.

Model Sentences

- Das ist die Frau, die hier arbeitet. - This is the woman who works here.
- Der Film, den wir sehen, ist neu. - The film that we watch is new.
- Der Mann, dem ich helfe, ist alt. - The man whom I help is old.
- Das Auto, das vor dem Haus steht, ist teuer. - The car standing in front of the house is expensive.

Mini Vocabulary

- der/die/das = who/which/that
- den = whom/that, masc acc.
- dem = whom, masc/neut dat.
- dessen = whose, masc/neut
- deren = whose, fem/pl

Study Note

- Do two checks for every relative pronoun: antecedent gender/number + grammatical case inside the relative clause.

LESSON 26 - PRACTICE

Relative Clauses

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Der Mann, er dort steht...	Der Mann, der dort steht...	Use a relative pronoun, not a repeated personal pronoun.
Die Frau, die ich helfe...	Die Frau, der ich helfe...	helfen requires dative.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Relative pronoun for der Mann as subject?	2. for die Frau as subject?
3. for das Kind as subject?	4. Masculine accusative relative pronoun?
5. Dative masculine/neuter relative pronoun?	6. Combine: Das ist der Mann. Ich kenne den Mann.
7. Correct punctuation: Die Stadt die ich mag ist klein.	8. Write one relative clause.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- Do two checks for every relative pronoun: antecedent gender/number + grammatical case inside the relative clause.

LESSON 27 - CORE GERMAN

Comparatives and Superlatives

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Form comparative and superlative adjectives.
- Use als and so...wie.
- Recognize common irregular comparison forms.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Comparative	Usually add -er.	schnell → schneller.
Superlative	Predicate/adverbial form often uses am + -sten/-esten.	am schnellsten.
als / wie	Use als after a comparative; use so...wie for equality.	größer als; so groß wie.
Irregular forms	gut → besser → am besten; viel → mehr → am meisten; gern → lieber → am liebsten.	Ich trinke lieber Tee.

Core Rules

- Many one-syllable adjectives may add an umlaut: alt → älter, groß → größer.
- Attributive superlatives take adjective endings: der beste Schüler.
- Use als, not wie, after a comparative in standard German.
- Equality uses so + adjective + wie.

Model Sentences

- Berlin ist größer als Bonn. - Berlin is larger than Bonn.
- Dieses Buch ist interessanter. - This book is more interesting.
- Er läuft am schnellsten. - He runs fastest.
- Ich esse lieber Reis. - I prefer eating rice.

Mini Vocabulary

- größer = bigger
- kleiner = smaller
- besser = better
- am besten = best
- lieber = preferably/rather

Study Note

- Use comparison in real descriptions: people, cities, prices, products, courses, and daily choices.

LESSON 27 - PRACTICE

Comparatives and Superlatives

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
mehr besser	besser	Do not use double comparative marking.
größer wie	größer als	Comparatives use als.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Comparative of klein?	2. Superlative of schnell?
3. Comparative of gut?	4. Complete: größer ____ ich.
5. Complete: so groß ____ du.	6. Translate: She is the best student.
7. Correct: mehr interessant.	8. Write one comparison with lieber.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- Use comparison in real descriptions: people, cities, prices, products, courses, and daily choices.

LESSON 28 - CORE GERMAN

Konjunktiv II: Polite Requests and Wishes

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Use würde + infinitive for hypothetical meaning.
- Use common forms hätte, wäre, könnte, müsste.
- Make polite requests and express wishes.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
würde + infinitive	A common general conditional/hypothetical form.	Ich würde gern reisen. - I would like to travel.
hätte / wäre	Common special forms of haben and sein.	Ich hätte gern einen Kaffee. / Wenn ich reich wäre...
könnte	Useful for polite requests and possibilities.	Könnten Sie mir helfen?
Conditional pattern	Wenn + Konjunktiv II clause can combine with a würde/main clause.	Wenn ich Zeit hätte, würde ich kommen.

Core Rules

- Polite requests often use könnten/würden rather than direct imperatives.
- Use hätte gern for polite ordering: Ich hätte gern...
- Avoid using würde with modal-like forms when a common special form is natural: könnte, müsste, sollte.
- The subordinate clause still sends its finite verb to the end.

Model Sentences

- Ich wäre gern zu Hause. - I wish I were at home.
- Wir würden mehr lernen. - We would learn more.
- Könntest du das wiederholen? - Could you repeat that?
- Wenn ich Geld hätte, würde ich reisen. - If I had money, I would travel.

Mini Vocabulary

- würde = would
- hätte = would have
- wäre = would be
- könnte = could
- gern = gladly/like to

Study Note

- Konjunktiv II is essential for polite German. Learn a few high-frequency forms before studying rarer literary forms.

LESSON 28 - PRACTICE

Konjunktiv II: Polite Requests and Wishes

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Ich würde kann kommen.	Ich könnte kommen.	Use the common Konjunktiv II form könnte.
Wenn ich habe Zeit, würde ich kommen.	Wenn ich Zeit hätte, würde ich kommen.	Use hätte for the hypothetical condition.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Translate: I would like a coffee.	2. Ask politely: Could you help me?
3. Complete: Wenn ich Zeit ____, würde ich kommen.	4. Konjunktiv II of sein?
5. of haben?	6. of können?
7. Correct: Ich würde gerne kann reisen.	8. Write one hypothetical sentence.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Konjunktiv II is essential for polite German. Learn a few high-frequency forms before studying rarer literary forms.

LESSON 29 - CORE GERMAN

Imperative and Polite Instructions

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Form informal singular, plural, and formal commands.
- Use *bitte* to soften instructions.
- Choose polite alternatives where appropriate.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
du imperative	Often use the verb stem, sometimes with -e.	Komm! - Come!; Warte! - Wait!
ihr imperative	Use the ihr present form without the pronoun.	Kommt! - Come, everyone!
Formal imperative	Use infinitive-like verb form + Sie.	Kommen Sie bitte! - Please come!
Polite alternatives	Could/would forms are often more courteous than direct commands.	Könnten Sie bitte warten?

Core Rules

- Sein is irregular: sei! / seid! / seien Sie!
- Separable prefixes remain at the end: Ruf mich an!
- Use *bitte* to make commands friendlier.
- In service and professional contexts, polite question forms may sound better than imperatives.

Model Sentences

- Öffne das Buch! - Open the book!
- Hört gut zu! - Listen carefully!
- Bitte sprechen Sie langsam. - Please speak slowly.
- Sei vorsichtig! - Be careful!

Mini Vocabulary

- kommen = to come
- warten = to wait
- öffnen = to open
- zuhören = to listen
- bitte = please

Study Note

- Commands are grammatically simple but socially sensitive. Match the form to du, ihr, or Sie and the level of politeness.

LESSON 29 - PRACTICE

Imperative and Polite Instructions

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Du komm!	Komm!	The du pronoun is normally omitted.
Anruf mich!	Ruf mich an!	anrufen is separable.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. du command: kommen.	2. ihr command: kommen.
3. formal command: warten.	4. du command: anrufen.
5. du command of sein.	6. Translate: Please sit down! formal.
7. Make more polite: Warten Sie!	8. Write one classroom instruction.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____

Remember

- Commands are grammatically simple but socially sensitive. Match the form to du, ihr, or Sie and the level of politeness.

LESSON 30 - CORE GERMAN

Passive Voice and Sentence Connectors

German examples with clear English explanations

Learning Objectives

- Form the present and past passive with werden.
- Distinguish active and passive focus.
- Connect ideas with common German linking words.

Concept	English explanation	German example + English meaning
Passive present	werden + past participle expresses an action done to the subject.	Das Haus wird gebaut. - The house is being built.
Passive past	Präteritum passive uses wurde/wurden + participle.	Das Haus wurde gebaut. - The house was built.
Agent	von + dative can name the person/agent.	Das Buch wurde von der Lehrerin geschrieben.
Connectors	und, aber, oder, denn keep main-clause order; deshalb/trotzdem cause inversion when first; weil/obwohl create verb-final subordinate clauses.	Es regnet, deshalb bleibe ich zu Hause.

Core Rules

- Passive is useful when the action/result matters more than the actor.
- Do not confuse werden passive with sein + adjective/state: Die Tür wird geöffnet vs Die Tür ist offen.
- Coordinating conjunctions such as und/aber do not push the verb to the end.
- Sentence adverbs such as deshalb take position 1 and are followed by the finite verb.

Model Sentences

- Die Straße wird repariert. - The road is being repaired.
- Das Essen wurde vorbereitet. - The food was prepared.
- Ich bin müde, trotzdem arbeite ich. - I am tired; nevertheless I work.
- Weil es spät ist, gehen wir. - Because it is late, we are leaving.

Mini Vocabulary

- werden = to become / passive auxiliary
- gebaut = built
- deshalb = therefore
- trotzdem = nevertheless
- weil = because

Study Note

- Strong German writing depends on both grammar and connectors. Choose connectors according to meaning and remember the word-order pattern they trigger.

LESSON 30 - PRACTICE

Passive Voice and Sentence Connectors

Common errors, guided practice, and independent production

Common error	Correct form	English explanation
Das Haus ist gebaut von ihnen. [action focus]	Das Haus wird von ihnen gebaut.	Use werden + participle for the action passive.
Deshalb ich bleibe zu Hause.	Deshalb bleibe ich zu Hause.	Verb-second rule after deshalb.

Guided Practice - answer without looking at the key

1. Present passive: Das Auto ___ repariert.	2. Past passive: Das Auto ___ repariert.
3. Translate: The letter is written by Anna.	4. Join with deshalb: Es regnet. Ich bleibe zu Hause.
5. Join with aber: Ich bin müde. Ich arbeite.	6. Join with weil: Ich lerne Deutsch. Ich brauche es.
7. Correct: Trotzdem ich gehe.	8. Write one passive sentence.

Mastery Challenge

- Write 5 original German sentences using the grammar from this lesson.
- Translate each sentence into English and underline the target structure.
- Read the German sentences aloud twice to connect grammar with pronunciation.

Answer Space / Personal Notes

- _____
- _____
- _____
- _____

Remember

- Strong German writing depends on both grammar and connectors. Choose connectors according to meaning and remember the word-order pattern they trigger.

REVISION 01

Foundations Review

Mixed practice - complete without looking back at the lessons.

No. / Topic	Question
1. German Alphabet and Pronunciation	How is "ei" normally pronounced?
2. German Alphabet and Pronunciation	How is "ie" normally pronounced?
3. German Alphabet and Pronunciation	What sound does German "w" usually represent?
4. Personal Pronouns and the Verb sein	Complete: Ich ___ müde.
5. Personal Pronouns and the Verb sein	Complete: Du ___ nett.
6. Personal Pronouns and the Verb sein	Complete: Wir ___ hier.
7. The Verb haben and Basic Sentence Patterns	Complete: Er ___ ein Buch.
8. The Verb haben and Basic Sentence Patterns	Complete: Wir ___ Hunger.
9. The Verb haben and Basic Sentence Patterns	Translate: I have time.
10. Noun Gender and Definite Articles	Article for Tisch?
11. Noun Gender and Definite Articles	Article for Schule?
12. Noun Gender and Definite Articles	Article for Kind?

Writing Task

- Write 70-100 words in German using at least four grammar points tested on this page.
- Underline the target structures and add a short English note naming each rule.

Self-Assessment

- 10-12 correct: strong control - continue to the next review.
- 7-9 correct: good progress - review repeated errors.
- 4-6 correct: return to the related lesson tables.
- 0-3 correct: restudy the English explanation and model sentences first.
- Writing check: verb position, case, article endings, and capitalized nouns.

REVISION 02

Nouns, Present Tense and Accusative

Mixed practice - complete without looking back at the lessons.

No. / Topic	Question
1. Indefinite Articles and Plural Nouns	Choose ein/eine: ___ Mann.
2. Indefinite Articles and Plural Nouns	Choose ein/eine: ___ Lampe.
3. Indefinite Articles and Plural Nouns	Choose ein/eine: ___ Auto.
4. Present Tense: Regular Verbs	Conjugate machen for ich.
5. Present Tense: Regular Verbs	Conjugate lernen for du.
6. Present Tense: Regular Verbs	Conjugate wohnen for er.
7. Stem-Changing and Irregular Present Verbs	du form of sehen?
8. Stem-Changing and Irregular Present Verbs	er form of fahren?
9. Stem-Changing and Irregular Present Verbs	du form of geben?
10. The Accusative Case	Change: der Mann → accusative.
11. The Accusative Case	Change: ein Hund → accusative.
12. The Accusative Case	Translate: I see the woman.

Writing Task

- Write 70-100 words in German using at least four grammar points tested on this page.
- Underline the target structures and add a short English note naming each rule.

Self-Assessment

- 10-12 correct: strong control - continue to the next review.
- 7-9 correct: good progress - review repeated errors.
- 4-6 correct: return to the related lesson tables.
- 0-3 correct: restudy the English explanation and model sentences first.
- Writing check: verb position, case, article endings, and capitalized nouns.

REVISION 03

Cases Review

Mixed practice - complete without looking back at the lessons.

No. / Topic	Question
1. The Dative Case	Dative of der Mann?
2. The Dative Case	Dative of die Frau?
3. The Dative Case	Dative of ein Kind?
4. Genitive and Possession	Genitive article for masculine?
5. Genitive and Possession	Genitive article for feminine?
6. Genitive and Possession	Complete: die Tür ___ Hauses.
7. Possessive Determiners	Translate: my father.
8. Possessive Determiners	Translate: my mother.
9. Possessive Determiners	Translate: his sister.
10. Modal Verbs	Translate: I can swim.
11. Modal Verbs	Translate: We must work.
12. Modal Verbs	Ask: May I come in?

Writing Task

- Write 70-100 words in German using at least four grammar points tested on this page.
- Underline the target structures and add a short English note naming each rule.

Self-Assessment

- 10-12 correct: strong control - continue to the next review.
- 7-9 correct: good progress - review repeated errors.
- 4-6 correct: return to the related lesson tables.
- 0-3 correct: restudy the English explanation and model sentences first.
- Writing check: verb position, case, article endings, and capitalized nouns.

REVISION 04

Verb Position and Questions

Mixed practice - complete without looking back at the lessons.

No. / Topic	Question
1. Separable and Inseparable Verbs	Separate: aufstehen in "I get up at 6."
2. Separable and Inseparable Verbs	Translate: I call my mother. (anrufen)
3. Separable and Inseparable Verbs	Is verstehen separable?
4. Word Order in Main Clauses	Reorder: heute / ich / arbeite.
5. Word Order in Main Clauses	Start with "Morgen": Ich fahre nach Tana.
6. Word Order in Main Clauses	Reorder: mit dem Bus / zur Schule / ich / fahre / jeden Tag.
7. Questions	Make a yes/no question: Du arbeitest heute.
8. Questions	Ask: Where do you live?
9. Questions	Ask: Where are you going?
10. Negation: nicht and kein	Choose: Ich habe nicht/kein Geld.
11. Negation: nicht and kein	Choose: Das ist nicht/kein interessant.
12. Negation: nicht and kein	Translate: She has no brother.

Writing Task

- Write 70-100 words in German using at least four grammar points tested on this page.
- Underline the target structures and add a short English note naming each rule.

Self-Assessment

- 10-12 correct: strong control - continue to the next review.
- 7-9 correct: good progress - review repeated errors.
- 4-6 correct: return to the related lesson tables.
- 0-3 correct: restudy the English explanation and model sentences first.
- Writing check: verb position, case, article endings, and capitalized nouns.

REVISION 05

Negation, Adjectives and Prepositions

Mixed practice - complete without looking back at the lessons.

No. / Topic	Question
1. Adjectives and Adjective Endings	Complete: der ___ Mann (gut).
2. Adjectives and Adjective Endings	Complete: eine ___ Frau (nett).
3. Adjectives and Adjective Endings	Complete: ein ___ Kind (klein).
4. Prepositions with Accusative or Dative	Case after für?
5. Prepositions with Accusative or Dative	Case after mit?
6. Prepositions with Accusative or Dative	Translate: with the teacher.
7. Two-Way Prepositions	Choose: Ich bin in der/die Stadt.
8. Two-Way Prepositions	Choose: Ich fahre in der/die Stadt.
9. Two-Way Prepositions	Contract: in das Haus.
10. Time, Dates, Numbers and Frequency	Preposition for 7:30?
11. Time, Dates, Numbers and Frequency	Preposition for Monday?
12. Time, Dates, Numbers and Frequency	Preposition for August?

Writing Task

- Write 70-100 words in German using at least four grammar points tested on this page.
- Underline the target structures and add a short English note naming each rule.

Self-Assessment

- 10-12 correct: strong control - continue to the next review.
- 7-9 correct: good progress - review repeated errors.
- 4-6 correct: return to the related lesson tables.
- 0-3 correct: restudy the English explanation and model sentences first.
- Writing check: verb position, case, article endings, and capitalized nouns.

REVISION 06

Time and Past/Future Tenses

Mixed practice - complete without looking back at the lessons.

No. / Topic	Question
1. The Perfect Tense: Perfekt	Participle of machen?
2. The Perfect Tense: Perfekt	Participle of lernen?
3. The Perfect Tense: Perfekt	Perfect: Ich ___ nach Berlin gefahren.
4. The Simple Past: Präteritum	Past of sein for ich?
5. The Simple Past: Präteritum	Past of haben for wir?
6. The Simple Past: Präteritum	Past of können for ich?
7. Future with werden	ich form of werden?
8. Future with werden	du form of werden?
9. Future with werden	Translate: It will rain.
10. Reflexive Verbs	Reflexive pronoun for ich?
11. Reflexive Verbs	for du?
12. Reflexive Verbs	for er?

Writing Task

- Write 70-100 words in German using at least four grammar points tested on this page.
- Underline the target structures and add a short English note naming each rule.

Self-Assessment

- 10-12 correct: strong control - continue to the next review.
- 7-9 correct: good progress - review repeated errors.
- 4-6 correct: return to the related lesson tables.
- 0-3 correct: restudy the English explanation and model sentences first.
- Writing check: verb position, case, article endings, and capitalized nouns.

REVISION 07

Complex Sentences

Mixed practice - complete without looking back at the lessons.

No. / Topic	Question
1. Subordinate Clauses	Complete: weil ich müde ____.
2. Subordinate Clauses	Order: dass / Deutsch / sie / lernt.
3. Subordinate Clauses	Join: Ich bleibe zu Hause. Ich bin krank.
4. Relative Clauses	Relative pronoun for der Mann as subject?
5. Relative Clauses	for die Frau as subject?
6. Relative Clauses	for das Kind as subject?
7. Comparatives and Superlatives	Comparative of klein?
8. Comparatives and Superlatives	Superlative of schnell?
9. Comparatives and Superlatives	Comparative of gut?
10. Konjunktiv II: Polite Requests and Wishes	Translate: I would like a coffee.
11. Konjunktiv II: Polite Requests and Wishes	Ask politely: Could you help me?
12. Konjunktiv II: Polite Requests and Wishes	Complete: Wenn ich Zeit ____, würde ich kommen.

Writing Task

- Write 70-100 words in German using at least four grammar points tested on this page.
- Underline the target structures and add a short English note naming each rule.

Self-Assessment

- 10-12 correct: strong control - continue to the next review.
- 7-9 correct: good progress - review repeated errors.
- 4-6 correct: return to the related lesson tables.
- 0-3 correct: restudy the English explanation and model sentences first.
- Writing check: verb position, case, article endings, and capitalized nouns.

REVISION 08

Advanced Review

Mixed practice - complete without looking back at the lessons.

No. / Topic	Question
1. Imperative and Polite Instructions	du command: kommen.
2. Imperative and Polite Instructions	ihr command: kommen.
3. Imperative and Polite Instructions	formal command: warten.
4. Passive Voice and Sentence Connectors	Present passive: Das Auto ___ repariert.
5. Passive Voice and Sentence Connectors	Past passive: Das Auto ___ repariert.
6. Passive Voice and Sentence Connectors	Translate: The letter is written by Anna.
7. Separable and Inseparable Verbs	Separate: aufstehen in "I get up at 6."
8. Separable and Inseparable Verbs	Translate: I call my mother. (anrufen)
9. Separable and Inseparable Verbs	Is verstehen separable?
10. The Simple Past: Präteritum	Past of sein for ich?
11. The Simple Past: Präteritum	Past of haben for wir?
12. The Simple Past: Präteritum	Past of können for ich?

Writing Task

- Write 70-100 words in German using at least four grammar points tested on this page.
- Underline the target structures and add a short English note naming each rule.

Self-Assessment

- 10-12 correct: strong control - continue to the next review.
- 7-9 correct: good progress - review repeated errors.
- 4-6 correct: return to the related lesson tables.
- 0-3 correct: restudy the English explanation and model sentences first.
- Writing check: verb position, case, article endings, and capitalized nouns.

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key - Part 1

Check answers only after completing the exercises independently.

Foundations Review

1. Like English "eye".	2. Usually like a long English "ee".	3. Usually /v/.	4. bin
5. bist	6. sind	7. hat	8. haben
9. Ich habe Zeit.	10. der	11. die	12. das

Nouns, Present Tense and Accusative

1. ein	2. eine	3. ein	4. mache
5. lernst	6. wohnt	7. siehst	8. fährt
9. gibst	10. den Mann	11. einen Hund	12. Ich sehe die Frau.

Correction Method

- For every wrong answer, rewrite the full correct German form.
- Write one sentence in English explaining the rule.
- Create one new German example with the same structure.
- If the same error appears twice, restudy that lesson before moving on.

Error Log

Item: _____ My answer: _____
 Correction: _____
 Rule in English: _____
 New German example: _____

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key - Part 2

Check answers only after completing the exercises independently.

Cases Review

1. dem Mann	2. der Frau	3. einem Kind	4. des
5. der	6. des	7. mein Vater	8. meine Mutter
9. seine Schwester	10. Ich kann schwimmen.	11. Wir müssen arbeiten.	12. Darf ich hereinkommen?

Verb Position and Questions

1. Ich stehe um 6 Uhr auf.	2. Ich rufe meine Mutter an.	3. No.	4. Heute arbeite ich.
5. Morgen fahre ich nach Tana.	6. Ich fahre jeden Tag mit dem Bus zur Schule.	7. Arbeitest du heute?	8. Wo wohnst du?
9. Wohin gehst du?	10. kein	11. nicht	12. Sie hat keinen Bruder.

Correction Method

- For every wrong answer, rewrite the full correct German form.
- Write one sentence in English explaining the rule.
- Create one new German example with the same structure.
- If the same error appears twice, restudy that lesson before moving on.

Error Log

Item: _____ My answer: _____
 Correction: _____
 Rule in English: _____
 New German example: _____

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key - Part 3

Check answers only after completing the exercises independently.

Negation, Adjectives and Prepositions

1. gute	2. nette	3. kleines	4. accusative
5. dative	6. mit dem Lehrer	7. in der Stadt	8. in die Stadt
9. ins Haus	10. um	11. am	12. im

Time and Past/Future Tenses

1. gemacht	2. gelernt	3. bin	4. war
5. hatten	6. konnte	7. werde	8. wirst
9. Es wird regnen.	10. mich	11. dich	12. sich

Correction Method

- For every wrong answer, rewrite the full correct German form.
- Write one sentence in English explaining the rule.
- Create one new German example with the same structure.
- If the same error appears twice, restudy that lesson before moving on.

Error Log

Item: _____ My answer: _____
 Correction: _____
 Rule in English: _____
 New German example: _____

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key - Part 4

Check answers only after completing the exercises independently.

Complex Sentences

1. bin	2. dass sie Deutsch lernt	3. Ich bleibe zu Hause, weil ich krank bin.	4. der
5. die	6. das	7. kleiner	8. am schnellsten
9. besser	10. Ich hätte gern einen Kaffee.	11. Könnten Sie mir helfen?	12. hätte

Advanced Review

1. Komm!	2. Kommt!	3. Warten Sie!	4. wird
5. wurde	6. Der Brief wird von Anna geschrieben.	7. Ich stehe um 6 Uhr auf.	8. Ich rufe meine Mutter an.
9. No.	10. war	11. hatten	12. konnte

Correction Method

- For every wrong answer, rewrite the full correct German form.
- Write one sentence in English explaining the rule.
- Create one new German example with the same structure.
- If the same error appears twice, restudy that lesson before moving on.

Error Log

Item: _____ My answer: _____
 Correction: _____
 Rule in English: _____
 New German example: _____

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key - Part 5

Check answers only after completing the exercises independently.

Lesson 1: German Alphabet and Pronunciation - 1) Like English "eye".; 2) Usually like a long English "ee".; 3) Usually /v/.; 4) ä, ö, ü, ß.

Lesson 2: Personal Pronouns and the Verb sein - 1) bin; 2) bist; 3) sind; 4) seid

Lesson 3: The Verb haben and Basic Sentence Patterns - 1) hat; 2) haben; 3) Ich habe Zeit.; 4) Sie hat zwei Brüder.

Lesson 4: Noun Gender and Definite Articles - 1) der; 2) die; 3) das; 4) die

Lesson 5: Indefinite Articles and Plural Nouns - 1) ein; 2) eine; 3) ein; 4) Frauen

Lesson 6: Present Tense: Regular Verbs - 1) mache; 2) lernst; 3) wohnt; 4) arbeitet

Lesson 7: Stem-Changing and Irregular Present Verbs - 1) siehst; 2) fährt; 3) gibst; 4) geben

Lesson 8: The Accusative Case - 1) den Mann; 2) einen Hund; 3) Ich sehe die Frau.; 4) Wir brauchen ein Auto.

Lesson 9: The Dative Case - 1) dem Mann; 2) der Frau; 3) einem Kind; 4) mir

Lesson 10: Genitive and Possession - 1) des; 2) der; 3) des; 4) Annas Buch

Lesson 11: Possessive Determiners - 1) mein Vater; 2) meine Mutter; 3) seine Schwester; 4) unser Haus

Lesson 12: Modal Verbs - 1) Ich kann schwimmen.; 2) Wir müssen arbeiten.; 3) Darf ich hereinkommen?; 4) Sie will Deutsch lernen.

Lesson 13: Separable and Inseparable Verbs - 1) Ich stehe um 6 Uhr auf.; 2) Ich rufe meine Mutter an.; 3) No.; 4) aufgemacht

Lesson 14: Word Order in Main Clauses - 1) Heute arbeite ich.; 2) Morgen fahre ich nach Tana.; 3) Ich fahre jeden Tag mit dem Bus zur Schule.; 4) Position 2.

Lesson 15: Questions - 1) Arbeitest du heute?; 2) Wo wohnst du?; 3) Wohin gehst du?; 4) Woher kommst du?

Focused Correction Drill

- Choose three lessons from this page. For each one, write one incorrect German sentence and then correct it.
- Under each correction, explain the grammar rule in one short English sentence.
- Read every corrected German sentence aloud twice.

Open-Ended Items and Personal Error Log

- Writing and speaking tasks can have many correct answers. Check word order, case, verb form, noun capitalization, and meaning.
- Error 1: _____ Correction: _____
- Error 2: _____ Correction: _____
- Error 3: _____ Correction: _____

ANSWER KEY

Answer Key - Part 6

Check answers only after completing the exercises independently.

Lesson 16: Negation: nicht and kein - 1) kein; 2) nicht; 3) Sie hat keinen Bruder.; 4) Wir sind nicht müde.

Lesson 17: Adjectives and Adjective Endings - 1) gute; 2) nette; 3) kleines; 4) neuen

Lesson 18: Prepositions with Accusative or Dative - 1) accusative; 2) dative; 3) mit dem Lehrer; 4) für das Kind

Lesson 19: Two-Way Prepositions - 1) in der Stadt; 2) in die Stadt; 3) ins Haus; 4) im Haus

Lesson 20: Time, Dates, Numbers and Frequency - 1) um; 2) am; 3) im; 4) jeden Tag

Lesson 21: The Perfect Tense: Perfekt - 1) gemacht; 2) gelernt; 3) bin; 4) haben

Lesson 22: The Simple Past: Präteritum - 1) war; 2) hatten; 3) konnte; 4) ging

Lesson 23: Future with werden - 1) werde; 2) wirst; 3) Es wird regnen.; 4) Wir werden viel lernen.

Lesson 24: Reflexive Verbs - 1) mich; 2) dich; 3) sich; 4) Wir treffen uns um 8 Uhr.

Lesson 25: Subordinate Clauses - 1) bin; 2) dass sie Deutsch lernt; 3) Ich bleibe zu Hause, weil ich krank bin.; 4) Wenn ich Zeit habe, komme ich.

Lesson 26: Relative Clauses - 1) der; 2) die; 3) das; 4) den

Lesson 27: Comparatives and Superlatives - 1) kleiner; 2) am schnellsten; 3) besser; 4) als

Lesson 28: Konjunktiv II: Polite Requests and Wishes - 1) Ich hätte gern einen Kaffee.; 2) Könnten Sie mir helfen?; 3) hätte; 4) wäre

Lesson 29: Imperative and Polite Instructions - 1) Komm!; 2) Kommt!; 3) Warten Sie!; 4) Ruf an! / Ruf mich an!

Lesson 30: Passive Voice and Sentence Connectors - 1) wird; 2) wurde; 3) Der Brief wird von Anna geschrieben.; 4) Es regnet, deshalb bleibe ich zu Hause.

Focused Correction Drill

- Choose three lessons from this page. For each one, write one incorrect German sentence and then correct it.
- Under each correction, explain the grammar rule in one short English sentence.
- Read every corrected German sentence aloud twice.

Open-Ended Items and Personal Error Log

- Writing and speaking tasks can have many correct answers. Check word order, case, verb form, noun capitalization, and meaning.
- Error 1: _____ Correction: _____
- Error 2: _____ Correction: _____
- Error 3: _____ Correction: _____

REFERENCE

High-Frequency Irregular German Verbs

Infinitive, present 3rd person, simple past, perfect form, and English meaning

Verb	3sg	Past	Perfect	English
sein	ist	war	ist gewesen	to be
haben	hat	hatte	hat gehabt	to have
werden	wird	wurde	ist geworden	to become
gehen	geht	ging	ist gegangen	to go
kommen	kommt	kam	ist gekommen	to come
fahren	fährt	fuhr	ist gefahren	to drive/go
sehen	sieht	sah	hat gesehen	to see
geben	gibt	gab	hat gegeben	to give
nehmen	nimmt	nahm	hat genommen	to take
sprechen	spricht	sprach	hat gesprochen	to speak
lesen	liest	las	hat gelesen	to read
essen	isst	aß	hat gegessen	to eat
trinken	trinkt	trank	hat getrunken	to drink
schlafen	schläft	schief	hat geschlafen	to sleep
helfen	hilft	half	hat geholfen	to help
treffen	trifft	traf	hat getroffen	to meet
finden	findet	fand	hat gefunden	to find
wissen	weiß	wusste	hat gewusst	to know
denken	denkt	dachte	hat gedacht	to think
bringen	bringt	brachte	hat gebracht	to bring

Verb	3sg	Past	Perfect	English
kennen	kennt	kannte	hat gekannt	to know/be familiar
bleiben	bleibt	blieb	ist geblieben	to stay
beginnen	beginnt	begann	hat begonnen	to begin
schreiben	schreibt	schrieb	hat geschrieben	to write
stehen	steht	stand	hat gestanden	to stand
liegen	liegt	lag	hat gelegen	to lie/be located
sitzen	sitzt	saß	hat gesessen	to sit
laufen	läuft	lief	ist gelaufen	to run/walk
fliegen	fliegt	flog	ist geflogen	to fly
fallen	fällt	fiel	ist gefallen	to fall
tragen	trägt	trug	hat getragen	to carry/wear
waschen	wäscht	wusch	hat gewaschen	to wash
vergessen	vergisst	vergaß	hat vergessen	to forget
verstehen	versteht	verstand	hat verstanden	to understand
gewinnen	gewinnt	gewann	hat gewonnen	to win
verlieren	verliert	verlor	hat verloren	to lose
tun	tut	tat	hat getan	to do
rufen	ruft	rief	hat gerufen	to call
halten	hält	hielt	hat gehalten	to hold/stop
lassen	lässt	ließ	hat gelassen	to let/leave

Irregular Verb Practice

- Write the Perfekt form: gehen → _____ ; sehen → _____ ; essen → _____ ; schreiben → _____ .
- Write the Präteritum form: sein → _____ ; haben → _____ ; können → _____ ; gehen → _____ .
- Create four short German past-tense sentences using verbs from the table and translate them into English.

My Five Difficult Verbs

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

Review these five forms again tomorrow and after one week.

REFERENCE

German Grammar Quick Guide

One-page review before writing, speaking, or an examination

Nouns	Capitalize every noun. Learn article + noun + plural: der Tisch, die Tische.
Articles	Nominative: der/die/das/die. Accusative masculine: den. Dative: dem/der/dem/den.
Verb 2	In a normal main statement, the finite verb is in position 2: Heute arbeite ich.
Questions	Yes/no: verb first. W-question: question word + verb + subject.
Separable verbs	Main clause: Ich stehe früh auf. Modal: Ich muss früh aufstehen.
Modals	Conjugated modal near the front + infinitive at the end: Ich kann Deutsch sprechen.
Negation	kein negates nouns with ein/zero article; nicht negates most other elements.
Two-way prepositions	Destination/wohin? → accusative. Location/wo? → dative.
Perfekt	haben/sein + participle at end: Ich habe gelernt. Ich bin gegangen.
Präteritum	Very common with war, hatte, konnte, musste; common in written narrative.
Subordinate clauses	weil/dass/wenn/obwohl → finite verb at the end: weil ich müde bin.
Relative clauses	Relative pronoun agrees with antecedent gender/number; case comes from its role inside the clause.
Comparison	größer als; so groß wie; gut → besser → am besten.
Polite German	Ich hätte gern... / Könnten Sie...? / Würden Sie...?
Passive	werden + past participle: Das Haus wird gebaut; past: Das Haus wurde gebaut.

Final Editing Checklist

1. Are all German nouns capitalized?
2. Is the finite verb in the correct position?
3. Are article/adjective endings consistent with gender, number, and case?
4. If there is a subordinate clause, is the finite verb at the end?
5. Did you choose the correct auxiliary and participle in Perfekt?

Next Steps

- Review your five most frequent errors, create ten new German sentences, and use them in a short conversation or paragraph. Repeated production is what turns grammar knowledge into language skill.